

to create surround sound effects, and is commonly seen in consumer-grade speaker sets and sound cards. This technology is also called AC3, and is used in DVD video to deliver surround sound.

4.3.21 THX

Loosely speaking, this is a certification that the playback device bearing the logo is of superior quality. The scheme was the brain-child of *Star Wars* creator George Lucas, who wanted his audience to experience his movies exactly as he had created it. This led to the need to ensure that every theatre in which his movie was screened met with stringent audio and video playback standards. So a THX-certified theatre offers the highest movie-viewing quality. This certification was later extended to home theatre systems as well.

4.3.22 Intra-aural Headphones

These are in the form of earplugs that are meant to be inserted into the ear canal.



Intra-aural headphones

4.4.23 Circumaural Headphones

The largest of the headphone types, these have large foam-padded ear cups that surround the ears. They are capable of significantly damping ambient noise. The spacious ear-cups can also hold comparatively larger speakers, or even multiple speakers, which offers the greatest frequency response.



Circumaural headphones

4.3.24 Supra-aural headphones

These headphones rest over the ear without enveloping them. They therefore allow ambient noise to interfere with sound reproduction.